



Module 3 - Writing Copy For Static Ads

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Introduction ►

In the last two lessons, we covered hooks and scripts for video ads.

Now we're moving into static ads.

This is where most people get it wrong.

They either copy their video hooks directly into statics, which doesn't work, or they rely on the image to do everything and treat the copy as an afterthought.

Both approaches kill performance.

Static ads are not a simplified version of video.

They're a completely different format with a different set of rules.

- You don't get time to explain.
- You don't get sequence.
- You don't get a second chance.

The viewer sees everything at once and decides in under two seconds whether this is worth their attention.

If your ad isn't instantly clear, it gets ignored.

In this lesson, we're going to fix that.

I'll show you how static ads are actually consumed, what each element is responsible for, and how to build them properly so they work together instead of competing.

We'll break down:

- Why most static ads fail
- The five elements that make up a high-performing static
- How to build the static hook using image, overlay, and headline
- How to write primary text that actually gets read
- How to write headlines that drive clicks instead of just describing your offer

By the end of this lesson, you'll be able to take the same angles you've already built and turn them into static ads that are clear, fast to understand, and built to convert.

This is where we move from "good looking ads" to ads that actually perform.

How Statics Are Consumed Differently To Video

Unlike video ads when we are using statics we are unable to control the sequence in which the viewer consumes information.

In a Video:

The viewer sees the hook first.

Then the body.

Then the CTA.

You guide them from attention → understanding → action, step by step.

When we run statics we aren't able to control this.

When someone scrolls past a static ad, they see everything at once.

The image.

The text overlay.

The headline.

The first line of the primary text.

There is no sequence or build up. They scan the entire ad in under two seconds and decide:

👉 “Do I understand this?”

👉 “Is this for me?”

👉 “Do I care?”

If the answer isn't immediately clear, they keep scrolling.

Video gives you time to explain.

Statics demand instant clarity.

The Anatomy Of A Static Ad

A static ad has five elements.

If you don't understand what each one is responsible for, you'll either overload one part or leave performance on the table.

Each element has a specific job and when they all do their job properly, the ad works.

When one fails, the whole ad underperforms.

In a video, the hook is a line.

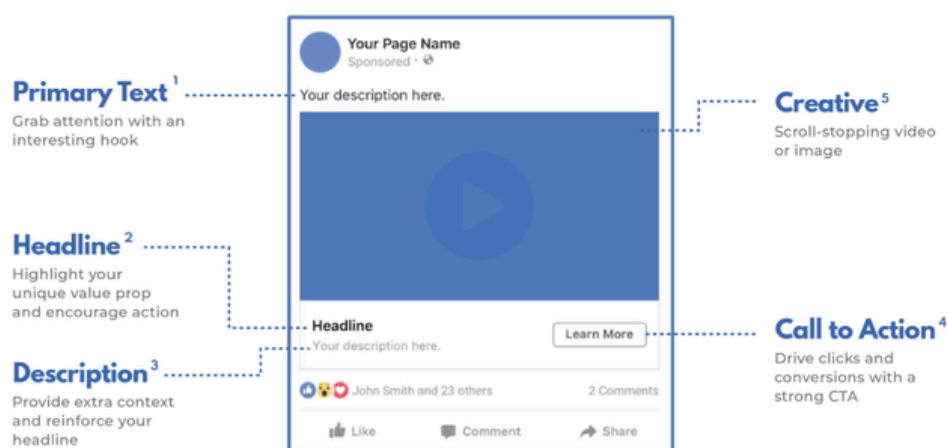
In statistics, the hook is a system.

Image + Overlay + Headline = the hook.

Everything starts from the hook you have already created.

We don't need to create anything new and can distribute our existing ideas across different elements.

Anatomy of a Perfect Facebook Ad



The 5 Elements 🔥

1. The Image

This is your scroll-stopper. It does the same job as the first 1–2 seconds of a video.

Its role is simple:

- 👉 Stop the scroll
- 👉 Signal relevance
- 👉 Represent the angle visually.

That's it. It doesn't need to explain everything.

If your hook is about *“going to the gym and not seeing results”*, your image should show that situation.

A good image makes the right person instantly think:

“This is about me.”

2. Text Overlay (Optional)

This is short copy placed on the image.

Its job is to be instantly clear, specific, and easy to process.

- 👉 Add clarity
- 👉 Reinforce the angle
- 👉 Support the overall hook

Your overlay should be built from the same angle and hook you've already created.

You're not writing new messaging.

You're taking one part of the hook and expressing it in a way that can be understood in under one second.

Example Hook:

"If you've been going to the gym to lose weight and it hasn't worked... here's how 100+ people are getting consistent results from home in 4–6 weeks."

From this hook, we can extract:

The problem → the gym isn't working
The audience → people trying to lose weight
The contrast → gym vs home
The result → consistent results

Your overlay should take one of these and express it clearly.

Not all of them. Just one.

What to avoid:

✗ *"If you've been going to the gym to lose weight and it hasn't worked... here's how 100+ people are getting consistent results from home in 4–6 weeks."*

- Too long.
- Too heavy.
- Not built for how statics are consumed.

Stronger versions:

- ✓ *"You train 4x a week and still look the same?"*
- ✓ *"Working out but not seeing any change?"*
- ✓ *"Putting in the effort but nothing's changing?"*



Each of these comes from the same hook but expresses a different part of it.

When combined with the image and headline, the full idea becomes clear instantly.

The hook is the idea.

The overlay is one expression of that idea, compressed for speed.

If your overlay could apply to any ad in your niche, it's too generic.

If it takes more than a second to read or understand, it's too heavy.

3. Headline

The headline sits below the creative. This is one of the most important elements in a static ad and one of the most misused.

A lot of people use the headline to describe the offer but it's job is to push the click.

In our statics system: Image + Overlay + Headline = Hook

The headline is where you introduce the tension, contrast, or question that makes the viewer want to engage.

We are not creating a new idea and your headline should be built from the same hook.

You are taking another part of that same hook and expressing it in a way that makes the next step feel obvious.

Example Hook:

"If you've been going to the gym to lose weight and it hasn't worked... here's how 100+ people are getting consistent results from home in 4-6 weeks."

From this hook, we can extract:

The problem → the gym isn't working

The contrast → gym vs home

The result → consistent results

The insight → what they're doing isn't working

Example Headlines:

"Why the gym isn't working for fat loss"

"Stop relying on the gym to lose weight"

"How people are getting results without the gym"

Each headline expresses a different part of the same idea.



When combined with the image and overlay, the full message becomes clear instantly.

What to avoid:

- ✗ “Online Fitness Coaching Program”
- ✗ “12 Week Transformation Plan”

These describe the offer, but on cold/low intent audiences, they don't create any reason to click.

There's no tension or contrast.

For more product-aware audiences, this can be effective.

If the viewer already:

- Knows what they want
- Is actively looking for a solution
- Recognises the offer

Then clarity can outperform curiosity.

Your headline should match the awareness level.

Cold audiences → use contrast, problems, tension

Warmer audiences → use clarity, outcome, specificity

Best Practice:

The headline should make ignoring the ad feel wrong.

Keep it short. 6–10 words.

Make it specific.

The goal is simple: Take the idea from your hook, and make the next step feel obvious.

4. Primary Text

We don't need to rewrite our main copy at this point. You have done this already in the previous lesson.

You already have:

- Your hook
- Your script
- Your structure

Problem → Solution

Before → After → Bridge

Myth → Truth

For our statics we don't need to redo this and can use what we already have.

We can use our full hook as our first line.

Just make sure that it fits within the character limits meta gives and can all be seen before the 'see more' button.

Sometimes we might need to condense it slightly.

Then continue straight into your script. After the first line, everything else stays the same.

Follow the same structure:

Problem agitation

Moment of realisation

Outcome

Mechanism

Social proof

Call to action

The Difference With Statics

Static copy is read, not watched so we need to make sure it's polished for easy reading.

- Shorter sentences
- Less filler
- More direct

The structure does not change.

What to Avoid:

- ✗ Writing completely new copy for statics
- ✗ Changing the angle or message
- ✗ Overcomplicating the first line

5. Call To Action (CTA)

Keep this simple and don't overthink it. Your CTA should match the action you want:

Learn More → lead gen

Sign Up → lead form

Shop Now → purchase

Biggest Mistakes ⚠



The biggest mistake people make is trying to make one element do everything.

- Image trying to explain the whole offer
- Overlay trying to be clever
- Headline repeating the same idea
- Primary text carrying all the weight

This can make the ad heavy, confusing and hard for viewers to comprehend easily.

The Correct Way To Think About It 🧠

Each element has one job:

Image → Stop + signal

Overlay → Clarify

Headline → Create tension

Primary text → Build belief

CTA → Direct action

When this happens the ad becomes easier to understand, easier to process and harder to ignore.

Quick Test

Look at your ad and ask:

Is the image clear instantly?

Does the overlay add clarity or noise?

Does the headline create curiosity or just describe?

Does the first line hit immediately?

If any part is weak you should go back and correct it.

The Static Hook System 🪝

Because a **static** is consumed all at once, the **hook** is not a single element. It is the combination of the image, the text overlay, and the **headline** working as one unit.

Think of it as a three-part system where each component has a specific role.

The image stops the scroll and signals the angle. It should visually represent the problem, the outcome, or the transformation the ad is communicating.

It does not need to be complicated. It needs to be immediately readable and relevant to the person you are trying to attract.



The text overlay adds clarity to the image. It answers the question the viewer is already asking: what is this about? Keep it to a few words.

Write it to be read in under one second. Avoid full sentences. Think of it as a label, not a line of copy.

The **headline** delivers the contrast or the question.

This is where you introduce the idea that makes the viewer want to keep reading. Use it to challenge what they already believe, highlight an unexpected result, or ask a direct question they cannot ignore.

This is the element that creates forward momentum into the **primary text**.

A simple way to think about the three parts together: the image says who this is for, the overlay says what it is about, and the **headline** gives them a reason to read more.

Writing Primary Text For Statics

The **primary text** is where you build the case. The same three frameworks we used for video scripts (Problem to Solution, Before After Bridge, and Myth to Truth) apply here. The difference is in how you write them.

Static copy is written to be read, not heard. This means;

- Shorter sentences.
- Simpler words.
- No conversational filler.

In a video script you can afford transitions and breathing room because the viewer is watching.

In a **static** the viewer is reading at their own pace, often while scrolling, and you lose them the moment the copy becomes dense or effortful.

The most important rule for **primary text**: **lead with your strongest idea.**

The first line must do the most work. It is visible before the See More cut, which means it is often the only line that gets read.

If that first line does not give the viewer a clear reason to keep reading, the rest of the copy is invisible.

A strong opening line for **static primary text** identifies the specific person the ad is for, names their problem or desire directly, and does it in as few words as possible. The goal is to make the right person immediately think: this is about me.

From there, the body of the **primary text** follows whichever framework matches the angle.

Problem to Solution works well for pain-led angles where the viewer already knows they have the problem.

Before After Bridge works well for transformation angles where you want them to feel the contrast emotionally.

Myth to Truth works well for objection or identity angles where you need to shift a belief before they will consider the offer.

Keep the overall length focused. **Static primary text** does not need to be long. Two to four short paragraphs is usually enough.

End with a clear, direct call to action that tells the viewer exactly what to do next and why.

Writing Headlines That Drive Clicks

The **headline** is the last thing the viewer sees before they decide whether to click. Most advertisers treat it as an afterthought, usually defaulting to their brand name or a vague description of the offer. This is a significant missed opportunity.

A strong **headline** does one of three things. It delivers a clear, specific benefit that makes the offer immediately appealing.

It asks a direct question the viewer cannot help but answer yes to. Or it creates a specific contrast that makes the offer feel like the obvious next step.

Headlines need to be short. Meta displays them in a limited space and long **headlines** get truncated. Aim for six to ten words as a general rule. Every word should earn its place. If you can remove a word without losing the meaning, remove it.

The **headline** and the **primary text** should not repeat each other. They are doing different jobs. The **primary text** builds the case. The **headline** closes it. Think of the **headline** as the last nudge before the click, not a summary of everything you just said.

Just like with video **hooks** and angles, you should test multiple **headline** variations against the same creative. The image and **primary text** can stay the same while you test two or three different **headlines**. Small changes here can have a meaningful impact on CTR without requiring new creative production.

Putting It Together



When briefing or writing a **static** ad, work through the five elements in this order.

Start with the angle. Every decision flows from this. Know who you are targeting, what problem or desire you are speaking to, and what the core idea of the ad is before you write a single word.

Brief the image. Describe what you need visually in terms of who it should feature, what it should communicate, and what emotion or situation it should convey. Be specific. A vague brief produces a vague image.

Write the text overlay if needed. Three to seven words. Clarity over cleverness. It should make the image more immediately readable, not compete with it.

Write the **primary text**. Lead with your strongest line. Follow the framework that suits the angle. End with a clear call to action. Keep it focused.

Write two or three **headline** variations. Make each one do something specific: benefit, question, or contrast. Test them and let the data tell you which lands.

Summary

Static ads are consumed differently to video. Everything is visible at once, which means every element has to work immediately and independently. There is no sequence to build in. Clarity and relevance have to be instant.

The **static hook** is a system of three parts: the image stops the scroll, the text overlay adds clarity, and the **headline** creates the question or contrast that drives the click. These three elements work together as one unit.

Primary text follows the same frameworks as video scripts but is written to be read rather than heard. Lead with your strongest line. Keep sentences short. End with a direct call to action.

Headlines are where CTR on **statics** is won or lost. Treat them as a testing variable in their own right. Keep them short, specific, and focused on benefit, question, or contrast.